

GAUTAM KUMAR

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Strategic Sourcing & Commodity Management professional with 8+ years of experience across rail, automotive, and manufacturing. Expertise in mechanical and structural commodities, RFQ/RFP management, supplier development, Tier-1 supplier management, commercial negotiations, should-cost analysis, LTAs, SAP MM, NPI, Lean Manufacturing, and Six Sigma. Delivered \$3.55M in savings through sourcing strategy, supplier negotiations, localization, and continuous improvement.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Strategic Sourcing • Commodity Management • RFQ/RFI/RFP • Global Procurement • Supplier Development • Tier-1 Suppliers • Contract & LTA Negotiation • Cost Estimation • Should-Cost Analysis • Supplier Risk Management • Stakeholder Management • SAP MM • Ariba • Power BI • Advanced Excel • Lean • Six Sigma
Manufacturing: Sheet Metal • Structural Fabrication • Stamping • Welding • Tube Bending • CNC Machining • Injection Molding • Die Casting • Assembly • Surface Finishing

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Buyer (NAM Region) | Alstom Transport | Jan 2023–Present

- Lead strategic sourcing for mechanical and structural commodities supporting North American rail vehicle programs; manage RFQ/RFP events, supplier selection, commercial negotiations, and commodity strategy.
- Source fabricated sheet metal, welded assemblies, machined components, structural fabrications, and long lead-time items for vehicle production and NPI programs.
- Partner with Engineering, Manufacturing, Quality, and Program teams supporting components produced through stamping, welding, tube bending, CNC machining, die casting, injection molding, assembly, and surface finishing.
- Delivered \$3.552M in cost savings and avoidance through sourcing strategy, localization, negotiations, demand planning, and commercial optimization.
- Perform supplier capability assessments, manufacturing process reviews, and should-cost analysis using material, labor, tooling, and market intelligence to close cost gaps.
- Negotiate pricing, payment terms, LTAs, and contracts while improving supplier Quality, Cost & Delivery (QCD); increased supplier performance to 90%+ OTIF.
- Lead DFQ and NPI sourcing for 800+ structural components, manage SAP purchase orders, forecasting, supplier reviews, risk mitigation, and cross-functional executive reviews.
- Apply Lean Manufacturing and Six Sigma principles to improve sourcing efficiency, reduce waste, shorten lead times, and strengthen supply continuity.

Global Supply Management Intern | Tesla | May 2022–Aug 2022

- Managed RFQs for manufacturing CAPEX and mechanical commodities; supplier onboarding, bid evaluation, and negotiations.
- Collaborated with engineering on supplier selection, manufacturing feasibility, NPI, contract management, and global supply continuity.

Supplier Coordinator | Alstom India | Oct 2019–Aug 2021

- Reduced supplier lead time by 4 weeks; improved supplier delivery by 30%, production shortages by 50%, and customer delivery by 30%.
- Led supplier development, localization, planning, forecasting, and cross-functional coordination for manufacturing programs.

Purchase Engineer | S.M. Auto & Autocomp | Jul 2017–Oct 2019

- Achieved 100% delivery performance for export consignments through supplier planning, follow-up, and JIT delivery coordination.
- Reduced inventory cost by 30% and delivered INR 1 Cr cost savings by localizing sheet-metal purchasing and improving sourcing decisions.
- Redeemed obsolete inventory worth INR 1.5 Cr and implemented returnable packaging for casting components to reduce damage risk.

Purchase Executive | Autocomp Corporation Panse Pvt. Ltd. | Pune, India | Jul 2017 - Jul 2018

- Delivered INR 65 Lacs cost reduction through alternate sourcing and supplier development while supporting zero production downtime for proprietary items.

EDUCATION

- DBA, Business Administration & Quantitative Methods, Belhaven University (Jan 2026 – Dec 2029)
- M.S., Industrial Engineering, University of Houston (Aug 2021 – Dec 2022)
- MBA, Manufacturing Management, BITS Pilani (Dec 2018 – Dec 2020)
- B.Tech., Mechanical Engineering, Punjab Technical University (May 2013 – May 2017)